CHARLES I, 1625-1649

Crown against Parliament

Il percorso, passo per passo

1 DIVINE RIGHT

kings chosen by God, his representatives on Earth;
absolute power;
total obedience expected

▼ **then**

2 TAXES AND CHURCH

taxes raised without the consent of Parliament;
absolute obedience to the *Church of England*

▼ **but**

3 PETITION OF RIGHT

1628: money for the war with France only if the king accepts:
no taxes without Parliament;
no prison without a good reason

▼ **still**

4 WILLIAM LAUD

Archbishop of Canterbury;
High Church worship; persecutes
the Puritans (thousands go to
America); later executed

▼ **so**

5 PERSONAL RULE

1629: disagreements get worse;
Charles shuts Parliament and
rules as a despot for
11 years (until 1640)

▼ **until**

6 THE 1640 PARLIAMENTS

1640: money for a war with Scotland;
Short Parliament: a month; then
Long Parliament: refuses funds,
aims to reduce the king's power

▼ **really**

7 CIVIL WAR 1642-49

Royalists (king, Anglican nobles)
v Roundheads (Parliament,
Puritans, middle class);
Ironsides win Marston Moor, Naseby

▼ **ends in**

8 1649

the king refuses to recognise
the court; Cromwell has the
death warrant signed;
beheaded in January 1649

▼ **beware**

9 COMMON MISTAKES

Royalists = Puritans (✗)
Short = Long Parliament (✗)
1628 = 1629 (✗)
king executed after Cromwell (✗)

Connessioni chiave

→ Segui i riquadri in ordine, da 1 a 9: è un unico racconto, non percorsi diversi.

→ The king (1) wants power and taxes without Parliament (2); Laud (4) helps him.

→ After 11 years alone (5), the Long Parliament (6) goes against him.

→ The Civil War (7) ends with the king beheaded in January 1649 (8). Last, the common mistakes (9).

Mappa 2 di 6 · Cromwell and the Commonwealth

THE COMMONWEALTH

1649-1660: England without a king

Il percorso, passo per passo

1 **1649: REPUBLIC**

England is proclaimed a Commonwealth (a Republic); the monarchy and the House of *Lords are abolished*

▼ **run by**

2 **RUMP PARLIAMENT**

until 1653 England is ruled by the House of Commons: only supporters of the Republic *can sit in it*

▼ **until**

3 **1650: REACTION**

the king’s execution causes a Royalist reaction in Ireland and Scotland; the Scottish revolt *is crushed at Dunbar*

▼ **then**

4 **1653: PROTECTOR**

Cromwell closes Parliament down;
he is appointed "Lord Protector
of the Realm":
a military dictator

▼ **rules**

5 **THREE COUNTRIES**

Cromwell rules over England,
Ireland and Scotland
as a military dictator

▼ **but**

6 **1655: RISING**

in March another Royalist
rising breaks out; so Cromwell
starts to rule the country
through the army

▼ **then**

7 1658

Cromwell is succeeded by
his son Richard, who
abdicates 8 months later;
the Republic falls apart

▼ **so**

8 THE END

the Republic falls apart;
the monarchy returns in 1660
with Charles II
(the Restoration)

▼ **beware**

9 COMMON MISTAKES

Rump = House of Lords (✗)
Dunbar = Naseby (✗)
Richard = Charles (✗)
Protector in 1649 (✗)

Connessioni chiave

→ Segui i riquadri in ordine, da 1 a 9: è un unico racconto, non percorsi diversi.

→ The Republic (1) is ruled by the Rump Parliament (2) until Cromwell closes it (4).

→ Cromwell, Lord Protector, rules three countries (5), then through the army (6).

→ In 1658 his son Richard (7) abdicates: the Republic falls apart (8). Last, the common mistakes (9).

JOHN MILTON

1608-1674: Puritan poet

Il percorso, passo per passo

1 LIFE

born in London in 1608, into a
Puritan family; St Paul's School
and Cambridge; he studies classical
and several modern languages

▼ **then**

2 FIRST PERIOD

Italian poems: L'Allegro and
Il Penseroso (1631), after Petrarch;
Latin and English poems;
Defensio (1651): supports Cromwell

▼ **then**

3 SECOND PERIOD

numerous political pamphlets
and prose works;
Areopagitica (1644): defence of
freedom of speech, against censorship

▼ **while**

4 POLITICS

he supports Cromwell and the
Puritans during the Civil War;
he defends the execution
of Charles I; blind by 1651

▼ **namely**

5 LIBERTIES

Milton defends religious, civil
and domestic liberties;
freedom of the press, of speech;
Parliament; divorce

▼ **then**

6 THIRD PERIOD

marked by blindness and poverty;
he produces his masterpiece,
Paradise Lost (1667)

▼ **then**

7 1660

he falls from grace with the
Restoration of Charles II; he hides,
is briefly arrested; poverty;
1664-1674: he devotes himself to poetry

▼ **then**

8 1674

Milton dies. A famous line:
"The mind is its own place,
and in itself can make a heaven
of hell, a hell of heaven"

▼ **beware**

9 COMMON MISTAKES

blind in 1608 (✗)
Areopagitica = poem (✗)
died in 1667 (✗)
Royalist supporter (✗)

Connessioni chiave

→ Segui i riquadri in ordine, da 1 a 9: è un unico racconto, non percorsi diversi.

→ A Puritan (1) who supported Cromwell (4) and defended freedom of speech (3, 5).

→ Three periods: poems (2), prose (3), the masterpiece (6). The Restoration (7) brought him poverty.

→ He dies in 1674 (8). Last, the common mistakes (9).

PARADISE LOST: PLOT

Genesis retold, 1667

Il percorso, passo per passo

1 CHAINED IN HELL

the poem begins with Satan
and his companion, Beelzebub,
chained to a lake of fire
in Hell

▼ **then**

2 THEY FREE THEMSELVES

they free themselves and want
to start another war
against God

▼ **so**

3 BEELZEBUB'S IDEA

Beelzebub suggests to corrupt
mankind, God's beloved
new creation: so Satan
goes to Eden

▼ **he goes**

4 THE SERPENT

Satan, as a serpent, compliments
Eve on her beauty; she asks how
he learned to speak; he says he
ate the fruit of the Tree

▼ **then**

5 EVE AND ADAM EAT

Eve eats the fruit; Adam is
horrified, but eats too:
he prefers to be fallen with
her than to remain pure

▼ **so**

6 GOD KNOWS

God knows immediately about
their disobedience
and decides the punishment

▼ **so**

7 PUNISHMENT

God first punishes the serpent:
it must crawl on the ground;
Adam and Eve are condemned
to pain and death

▼ later

8 REDEMPTION

the archangel Michael shows
them the future of mankind;
comforted by a vision of
redemption, they leave Eden

▼ beware

9 COMMON MISTAKES

Adam eats first (✗)
Michael punishes (✗)
Satan stays in Hell (✗)
God learns it later (✗)

Connessioni chiave

→ Segui i riquadri in ordine, da 1 a 9: è un unico racconto, non percorsi diversi.

→ In Hell Satan (1) frees himself (2); Beelzebub’s idea (3) leads to the serpent (4).

→ Eve and Adam eat the fruit (5); God knows at once (6) and punishes them (7).

→ Michael shows a vision of redemption (8). Last, the common mistakes (9).

PARADISE LOST: IDEAS

themes, universe, Satan, style

Il percorso, passo per passo

1 TWO PATHS

Adam and Eve's disobedience, in
Satan's rebellion against God;
Satan: sin, degradation, punishment
Man: repentance, hope of redemption

▼ within

2 FOUR REALMS

geography based on religion,
not on science: glorious Heaven
(above), dreadful Hell (below),
confusing Chaos, a young Earth

▼ namely

3 SATAN

refuses God's superiority and
is banished to Hell; he says:
"Better to reign in Hell than
serve in Heaven"

▼ namely

4 THEMES

disobedience (Satan, Adam, Eve);
rebellion (Satan); redemption
through repentance; God's
grace and mercy save humanity

▼ **from**

5 HIERARCHY

from close to far from God:
the Son, archangels and cherubs,
humans, animals,
devils (fallen angels)

▼ **first**

6 HEROIC, THEN LOW

God is always more powerful, but
Milton respects Satan's courage;
at first heroic, in the end
degraded, dominated by vanity

▼ **namely**

7 STYLE

a complex work for highly-educated readers: obscure allusions, archaic vocabulary, complex *grammar, extended similes*

▼ **namely**

8 METER

blank verse: unrhymed iambic pentameters, as used by Marlowe and Shakespeare; Milton thought *rhyme unsuitable for his subject*

▼ **beware**

9 COMMON MISTAKES

Satan chooses redemption (✗)

science-based universe (✗)

rhymed verse (✗)

Adam and Eve are damned (✗)

Connessioni chiave

→ Segui i riquadri in ordine, da 1 a 9: è un unico racconto, non percorsi diversi.

→ Two moral paths (1): Satan chooses damnation; Adam and Eve, redemption.

→ The universe has four realms (2) and a hierarchy by closeness to God (5).

→ Satan (3, 6) looks heroic, then degraded; style (7) is complex; blank verse (8). Last, the mistakes (9).

FROM CHARLES I TO PARADISE LOST

how the topics are connected

Il percorso, passo per passo

1 CIVIL WAR

Charles I, Divine Right;
Petition of Right 1628;
war 1642-49 (Royalists v
Roundheads); beheaded 1649

▼ **then**

2 COMMONWEALTH

Republic 1649; Rump Parliament;
Cromwell Lord Protector 1653;
Richard 1658; the monarchy
returns in 1660

▼ **then**

3 JOHN MILTON

1608-1674; Puritan poet;
supports Cromwell; Areopagitica;
blind; falls from grace in 1660;
Paradise Lost 1667

▼ **meanwhile**

4 PARADISE LOST: PLOT

Satan chained in Hell, rebels;
the serpent tempts Eve;
Eve and Adam eat; punishment;
Michael: redemption

▼ then

5 PARADISE LOST: IDEAS

themes: disobedience, rebellion,
redemption; four realms;
Satan heroic, then low;
blank verse

▼ then

6 DATES TO REMEMBER

1625 Charles I; 1642-49 war;
1649 republic; 1653 Protector;
1658 Cromwell's end;
Milton 1608-1674, PL 1667

▼ beware

7 MOST COMMON MISTAKE

Royalists (king) and
Roundheads (Parliament)
mixed up; Short and Long
Parliament mixed up

▼ so

8 WHAT YOU MUST KNOW FOR THE INTERROGATION

history 1625-1660: Charles I, the Civil War, the Commonwealth, Cromwell

John Milton: life, works, politics

Paradise Lost: plot, themes, Satan, style

Connessioni chiave

→ Segui i riquadri in ordine, da 1 a 8: è un unico racconto, non percorsi diversi.

→ Civil War (1), Commonwealth (2), then John Milton (3) and his masterpiece Paradise Lost: plot (4) and ideas (5).

→ Learn the dates (6); beware of the most common mistake (7).